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NWSC Computer Representative Training Guide

A field manual for circuit Computer Representatives running NWSC dual meets with SwimTopia and Meet Maestro.

About This Guide

This guide walks a Computer Representative through every stage of a regular-season NWSC dual meet, from the week-of preparation in SwimTopia through post-meet results transfer. It is built around the NWSC 2025 Meet Operations Manual (MOM) deadlines and the day-of workflow that has evolved across the circuit. Cross-references throughout this guide cite specific MOM sections so you can trace any policy back to its source.

> ***A note on this guide's existence.*** *The NWSC league site provides training materials for Stroke/Turn/Exchange Judges, Head Timers, and Starters, but does not publish circuit-wide Computer Rep training material. This guide fills that gap. It is not an official NWSC document, and any conflict between it and the current MOM should be resolved in favor of the MOM.*

Who this is for

- New Computer Representatives preparing to run their first meet
- Returning Computer Reps who want a refresher
- Backup or shadow volunteers learning the role

Learning objectives

After working through this guide, a Computer Rep should be able to:

1. Prepare a SwimTopia meet for merge into Meet Maestro on schedule
2. Generate, save, and distribute heat sheets and pre-meet reports
3. Manage check-ins, reseeds, scratches, and deck entries on meet day
4. Enter and validate results during the meet, including DQs
5. Print awards, ribbons, and time-improvement labels at the right intervals
6. Lock the meet, transfer results, and update record books post-meet

How content is classified

Every step in this guide carries one of three tags so you can tell what's mandatory from what's just one team's habit:

- 📋 **REQUIRED** — Mandated by the NWSC Meet Operations Manual or NWSC Board policy. Skipping or modifying these requires Meet Director agreement (and sometimes Board approval).
- 💡 **RECOMMENDED** — Circuit-wide best practice that most or all teams follow. Not strictly required, but strongly suggested for smooth meets.

- ⭐ **STEINER PRACTICE** — One team's specific approach. Useful as a reference, but every team should adapt to their own conventions, file structures, and printer setups.

Each tag uses both a semantic emoji (📋 clipboard for required, 💡 lightbulb for recommended, ⭐ star for Steiner) and bold uppercase text so the document is readable in color or black-and-white. Sections are tagged at the top of each subsection. Where a single section mixes categories, inline callouts flag the specific item.

Other icons

- 🛫 marks tasks specific to **away** meets (visiting Computer Rep)
- 🏠 marks tasks specific to **home** meets (host Computer Rep)
- 🖨️ marks printing tasks

External references link to the SwimTopia Help Center — bookmark it. The Meet Maestro section is the most useful starting point during a live meet.

Role Overview

📋 **REQUIRED**

The Computer Rep is the data backbone of the meet. Per MOM §1.3.7, every team must provide at least one trained Computer Rep, and training is required annually regardless of experience.

Core responsibilities (MOM §1.3.7.3 / §1.3.7.4):

- Setting up or receiving the meet database and ensuring it merges cleanly
- Producing accurate heat sheets and session reports on time
- Entering scratches, deck adds, and reseeded relays as the meet unfolds
- Recording official times and processing DQ slips
- Producing labels, ribbons, and the final results package

The two flavors of the role:

- **Home Computer Rep** owns the meet database, the printers, the network, and the final published results.
- **Visiting Computer Rep** assists the home rep, ensures their team's entries and changes are reflected accurately, and retains a copy of the final results.

Whichever side you sit on, your goal is the same: an accurate, on-time meet with no surprises for coaches, scorers, or families.

Pre-Meet Deadlines (Reference)

📋 **REQUIRED** — These deadlines come from MOM §2.2.1 and are non-negotiable for official meets.

Deadline	Deliverable	From	To
Sunday midnight	Host Pool Guide	Home Meet Director	Visiting Meet Director

Deadline	Deliverable	From	To
Monday midnight	Initial competitive and concession deviations	Both Meet Directors	Both Meet Directors
Tuesday midnight	Visiting team database	Visiting Computer Rep	Home Computer Rep
Wednesday midnight	Merged meet database	Home Computer Rep	Both Meet Directors, Visiting Computer Rep
Thursday 8 PM	Meet schedule (heat sheet)	Home Computer Rep	Both Meet Directors, Visiting Computer Rep
Friday 8 PM	Final preparatory deviations & readiness	Both Meet Directors	Both Meet Directors

Meet day entry-change deadlines

📋 **REQUIRED** — These come from MOM §1.3.7.4 and govern when each segment of the meet locks for changes.

Deadline	What locks
30 minutes before meet start	Beginning relays (events 1–11)
Start of meet	First-half individual events (12–47, ending after 6&U Breast)
Start of event 24 (IM)	Second-half individual events (48–77)
Start of event 58 (long free)	Ending relays (events 78–87)

> ***A note on event numbering across seasons.*** *The 2025 MOM included a transitional event order in Appendix C1 that ran through event 91 by listing both 25 Yd and 50 Yd versions of 11-12 Breast and 11-12 Fly. For the 2026 season, the duplicate 25 Yd versions of those 11-12 events drop, returning the meet to 87 events with the deadline numbers above lining up cleanly to stroke-group transitions. If you're loading historical 2025 data, expect events 50–51, 54–55, 74–75, and 76–77 to refer to different content than the same numbers in 2026.*

Phase 1 — Pre-Meet Setup

1.1 Confirm absences (Team Coordinator hand-off)

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

Before merging, every absence the team has on file must be reflected in SwimTopia entries and relays. There are two stages to be aware of:

Stage 1 — Initial registration (the baseline). SwimTopia's meet registration is the canonical entry list: families sign up for a meet through the team's SwimTopia site, the Team Coordinator and Head Coach review and confirm entries, and registration closes on a team-defined deadline (typically several days before the visiting database is due). Whatever's in SwimTopia at registration close is the baseline roster for the meet. Few absence changes typically arrive before this point because families are still actively signing up.

Stage 2 — Post-registration changes (the part that needs tracking). Once meet registration locks, families need an alternative mechanism to communicate absences or other changes. This is where the form / email / text channels come in — and this is where most absence changes actually occur. By the **Tuesday midnight visiting database deadline (per MOM §2.2.1)**, the visiting team's data is committed, but absences can still arrive between Tuesday and the meet itself. Tracking these late changes is the important part: each one may surface a new opportunity to condense or consolidate the meet (see §1.4 on adding combos in response to late entry changes).

The most common pattern across the circuit for Stage 2:

1. **Families submit absences through an online form** (Google Form, Microsoft Form, or a SwimTopia-integrated form) once registration has closed.
2. **The form auto-logs each submission** to a persisted store — usually a Google Sheet or equivalent — so there's a single source of truth the volunteer team can reference.
3. **The form sends a notification** to the appropriate volunteer or board member (often the Team Coordinator, sometimes the Head Coach or Computer Rep directly) so absences don't sit in a queue unread.

Some teams use SwimTopia's own attendance tracking instead, and a few still operate via direct email or text to the Team Coordinator. Whatever the input mechanism, by the time you're ready to merge, every Stage 2 change should be reflected in SwimTopia entries on top of the Stage 1 baseline.

Steps for the Computer Rep:

1. Get the consolidated absence list from your Team Coordinator (or pull it directly from your team's absence sheet/form responses if you have access).
2. In SwimTopia, run the **Meet Entries by Athlete** report (Manage Team → Reports → Meet Entries By Athlete) and verify each absent swimmer is unchecked from their events. See SwimTopia Pre-Meet Reports.
3. Run the **Relay Report** (Manage Team → Reports → Relay Report) to identify any incomplete relays caused by absences.
4. Review incomplete relays with the Head Coach. Decide which will be re-seeded with eligible swimmers and which will swim as exhibition (a relay that cannot score because it lacks four eligible swimmers).

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Steiner uses a Google Form for families to report absences after meet registration closes, which logs entries to a shared "Meet Absences Sheet" maintained by the Team Coordinator and notifies the Team Coordinator on each submission. The sheet is the single source of truth that the Computer Rep cross-references against SwimTopia entries before the Wednesday merge. Other teams will have their own form/sheet/notification setup — the principle is the same: get post-registration absences logged somewhere durable, notified to a human, and reconciled into SwimTopia before merge.*
>
> 💡 ***Tip:*** *The SwimTopia Meet Entries matrix view (Schedule → Meet → Entries) is the fastest way to flip attendance for many swimmers at once. See Meet Entries.*

1.2 Lock and publish to Meet Maestro

📋 **REQUIRED** (locking and merging) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (timing)

Per MOM §2.2.1, two roles operate on different deadlines:

- 🛫 **Visiting Computer Rep:** locks the meet and marks Ready in SwimTopia by **Tuesday midnight**. This sends the visiting team's database to the Home Computer Rep.
- 🏠 **Home Computer Rep:** locks and marks Ready, receives the visiting database by Tuesday midnight, then merges into a single Meet Maestro database. The merged database must be delivered to all directors and the Visiting Computer Rep by **Wednesday midnight**. The Meet Schedule (heat sheet) follows by **Thursday 8 PM** (§1.7).

Both roles use the same SwimTopia steps to lock and mark Ready:

1. In SwimTopia, open the meet and go to **Merge/Export**.
2. Toggle **Lock out all entry changes** to **On**. This closes athlete signups automatically.
3. On the Meet Maestro tab, slide your team's status to **Ready**. The visiting team's Ready triggers the database transfer; the home team's Ready (after both teams have done so) makes the visiting entries available for merge.
4. (🏠 home only, after both teams are Ready) Confirm the appropriate **record books** are attached. Record books selected at this point — after entries are locked from both teams but before the merge — become available in Meet Maestro reports. Adding them later requires going through Meet Maestro Settings → Benchmarks. See Benchmarks (Records & Time Standards).

The full reference is in SwimTopia Meet Entries – Ready to Merge.

1.3 🏠 Home Meet Maestro settings

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

Once both teams are marked Ready, the home Computer Rep clicks **Build Meet in Meet Maestro** to merge entries and create the meet. Then review settings:

- **Start time and per-heat padding.** Meet Maestro estimates timing using a base padding per heat. Padding values are not specified by NWSC and vary by team — set them based on your starter's pace and historical meet duration. ⭐ *Steiner: Currently uses ~30 seconds per individual heat / 15 seconds per relay heat; older Steiner settings ran longer.*
- **Scheduled breaks.** Add breaks for shift changes (typically after event 45) and the parent/coach relay if your team runs one. ⭐ *Steiner: Allocates ~20 minutes for the parent/coach relay.* Some teams optionally add 2-minute breaks for timer "shuffles" between 25-yard and 50-yard events; others skip these and recover time through faster-than-estimated starts. See Meet Maestro Settings – Meet Setup & Sessions.
- **Seeding & Scoring rules.** These come over from the SwimTopia Meet Template, but verify them in Meet Maestro Settings → Seeding & Scoring before printing heat sheets. See Meet Maestro Settings – Seeding & Scoring.

1.4 Coordinate combo and relay decisions with the Meet Directors

📋 **REQUIRED** (Meet Director sign-off on combos and final entries per MOM §2.2.1 / §2.3.3) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (the coordination workflow below)

Once the merge is complete and you can see entries from both teams in Meet Maestro, the next priority is finalizing the combo plan **before producing any documents from the merged data**. Combos change lane assignments, which directly change the contents of heat sheets and check-in sheets. They also affect actual meet runtime (combined heats run as a single race), though as noted in §1.6 the Session Report's time estimate doesn't reflect that. Settling combos first means each subsequent print or distribution reflects the actual approved meet plan.

The Computer Rep does not unilaterally decide whether to combine heats or change relay compositions. Those decisions belong to the **Home and Visiting Meet Directors**, advised by the Head Coaches. The Computer Rep's job is to surface what's changing in the data and execute the directors' decisions in Meet Maestro before each MOM deadline.

This is the coordination loop that runs from Sunday evening through Friday 8 PM. It is iterative because absences keep arriving across the week — each new scratch can break a previously-agreed combo or leave a relay short.

Who decides what:

Decision	Owner	Computer Rep's role
Whether to combine heats	Home Meet Director (with Visiting MD agreement)	Identify candidate heats from current entries; flag changes when scratches alter the picture
Final relay compositions	Head Coach	Run Relay Report on demand; flag broken or exhibition relays after each scratch wave
Whether to drop or keep a relay short of 4 swimmers	Head Coach + Meet Director	Mark as exhibition in Meet Maestro per the coach's instruction
Lane assignments inside a combined heat	Computer Rep, following the Home MD's general guidance (e.g., similar age groups together; broken heats to outside lanes)	Implement and document on the combined-heats reference doc
Final pre-meet deviations	Both Meet Directors	Implement in Meet Maestro and confirm to both directors

The week's flow:

1. **Sunday → Monday.** Pool guide and initial concession deviations exchanged between Meet Directors. The Computer Rep is mostly observing here; absence list is still firming up.
2. **Tuesday midnight (visiting database deadline).** Visiting Computer Rep pushes their database to Home Computer Rep. Home Computer Rep now has full entries from both teams and can identify likely combo candidates (small heats, lonely swimmers in age groups, etc.).

3. **Wednesday afternoon.** Home Computer Rep shares a draft list of candidate combos with the Home Meet Director. The Home MD reviews and confers with the Visiting MD as needed. If both directors agree, the combo plan goes into the combined-heats reference document, and lane assignments are implemented in Meet Maestro.
4. **Wednesday midnight (meet database deadline per MOM §2.2.1).** Home Computer Rep delivers the merged meet database to all directors and the Visiting Computer Rep, with combos reflected.
5. **Thursday 8 PM (heat sheet deadline per MOM §2.2.1).** Heat sheets distributed (see §1.7 below). Combo plan locked in writing. Both Visiting MDs and Computer Reps now know what's planned.
6. **Friday evening.** Late absences arrive. See §2.1 for the Friday final pass — this is where the combo plan is checked one more time, though changes are typically additive (new combos to save time) rather than restructuring what's already approved.

Adjustments after the initial combo plan is in place:

Once the initial combo plan is locked Wednesday afternoon and reflected in the Wednesday-night merge, **changes to existing combos are uncommon**. The default response to a late scratch is to leave the combo as planned and let the affected lanes sit empty in the smaller heat — that's far less disruptive than re-issuing heat sheets and re-briefing officials.

Two situations do call for changes, both at Meet Director discretion:

- **Adding more combos** to further condense the meet. This is the most common late-week combo change, and the typical reason for it is hard external time pressure: an HOA noise ordinance, facility close time, lifeguard contract, daylight, or a tight-on-time meet projection that needs more compression. Late absences often surface additional small heats that can be combined to save time. This is also lower-risk than restructuring existing combos because it only adds material rather than shifting what's already approved.
- **Restructuring or dropping an existing combo.** Reserved for cases where the entries underlying the combo have changed in a way that invalidates its basis — for example, a key heat shrinks below the threshold where combining still works, the swimmers in the combined heats no longer make sense together, or a previously-approved combo no longer reflects the current rosters. Note that restructuring or dropping a combo *adds* time rather than saving it (it un-compresses the meet), so this isn't done for runtime reasons. Outside of those entry-driven cases, "leave it alone" is usually the right call even if the combo is now lopsided.

When either change is on the table, the Computer Rep flags the situation to the Home Meet Director with the specific impact (events affected, swimmers affected, projected time saved or lost). The Home and Visiting Meet Directors then decide together. Per MOM §2.2.1, final preparatory deviations are due Friday 8 PM, so any change must land before that deadline. If a combo change happens after heat sheets have already been distributed, **send an updated combined-heats reference doc** to the Visiting Computer Rep, both Meet Directors, and meet-coordinator roles on both teams, and **re-issue the affected heat sheets** so everyone is working from the same plan.

> 💡 ***Tip:*** *Keep your "candidate combos" working list separate from the "approved combos" reference doc. Coaches and tent parents only need to see the approved version. Your working list is a Computer Rep tool for tracking what's still under discussion.*

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Steiner tracks combo discussions in its Meet Notes document alongside the relay-restrictions table, so Saturday morning's reseed reviewer can see both "what we agreed to" and "why we agreed to it" in one place.*
>
> ***What are Meet Notes?*** *A Steiner workflow artifact: a single per-meet document (typically a Google Doc) that gathers all the human-readable context for a meet — combo discussions, relay restrictions, swimmer constraints (early departures, no-medley-relay flags), late absences, and any judgment calls the Computer Rep needs to remember on meet morning. It travels alongside the Meet Maestro database as the "why" companion to the database's "what." Other teams achieve the same outcome through different channels — verbal handoffs with the coach, Slack threads, shared spreadsheets, or just relying on the Computer Rep's memory. If your team doesn't already follow a Meet Notes practice, you don't need to start one to be effective; the principle is just to make sure that on Saturday morning, whoever is doing the reseed can answer "did we already think about this?" without having to track down a coach mid-warm-up.*
>
> 💡 ***Tooling note:*** *SwimTopia does not manage combos natively, and Meet Maestro does not provide a facility for reseeding relays after the merge. Many teams have built their own utilities to fill this gap — Excel macros, Google Sheets formulas, Python scripts, or other small programs that pull data from SwimTopia or Meet Maestro exports and produce ranked lists or recommended seedings. If your team has one, learn its conventions early; if not, the manual approaches in §3.2 (medley reseed) and §4.5 (free reseed) are what most Computer Reps fall back to.*

1.5 🖨️ Print and save check-in sheets

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

Print copies of the **Athlete Check-in** sheet from Meet Maestro for the prep/tent team to use during morning check-in. Save a PDF copy for archival. Because combos are already locked in by §1.4, the lane assignments on these sheets reflect the approved plan.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Print 2 single-sided copies. Save the PDF in* `YYYY/YYYYMMDD - Away vs Home/HeatSheets/CheckIn.pdf`*. Other teams will use whatever folder convention or shared drive structure suits them.*

See [Meet Maestro Settings – Pre-Meet Reports: Athlete Check-In].

1.6 Save and share session report

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

Run the **Session Report** from Meet Maestro and email a PDF to the people who need it (typically Head Coach, Team Coordinator, Meet Coordinator).

> 💡 ***Important:*** *The Session Report's event schedule and time estimate* ***do not reflect the impact of combos****. Because combos are implemented by moving athletes into non-overlapping lanes within a single underlying heat, Meet Maestro still counts each combined component as a separate heat in its time projection. Recipients reviewing the Session Report should know the actual meet runtime will be shorter than the report suggests — by roughly the per-heat padding times the number of combined heats. This is worth calling out explicitly when distributing the report so coaches and coordinators don't plan around an inflated estimate.*
>
> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Save to* `.../HeatSheets/SessionReport.pdf` *and email to head-coach, team-coordinator, and meet-coordinator role addresses. Distribution lists vary by team.*

1.7 Save and share preliminary heat sheets

📋 **REQUIRED** (Thursday 8 PM delivery deadline) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (distribution and archival method)

Per MOM §2.2.1, the Home Computer Rep must deliver the **Meet Schedule (Heat Sheet)** to the Home Meet Director, Visiting Computer Rep, and Visiting Meet Director by **Thursday 8 PM**. How you save and distribute beyond that minimum is up to your team.

By this point the combo plan from §1.4 is already implemented in Meet Maestro, so the heat sheets you produce here reflect the approved meet plan. If combos change after this distribution, the heat sheets need to be re-issued (see §1.4's "When a scratch breaks a planned combo" guidance).

💡 **Recommended:** Save a PDF of the heat sheets and share with your Team Coordinator to publish on the team website.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Save to* `.../HeatSheets/HSF_FM.pdf` *(all teams, full schedule — see §3.4 for Steiner's HS/HSF file naming convention) and email to the Team Coordinator for website posting.*

1.8 ⭐ Save useful backup reports

⭐ **STEINER PRACTICE**

Steiner saves these from SwimTopia in case the network drops on meet morning and relays need to be re-seeded manually:

- **Athlete Report Card** (Manage Team → Reports → Athlete Performance → Athlete Report Card)
- **Best Times** (Manage Team → Reports → Athlete Performance → Best Times)

Early in the season, including the prior season's times is useful since few current-season times exist yet.

This is a defensive habit, not a requirement. Other teams rely on Meet Maestro's offline support and skip this step. If your team is comfortable with the offline experience, you can too.

Phase 2 — Friday Final Prep

2.1 Friday final pass — confirm absences, relays, and combos

📋 **REQUIRED** (final preparatory deviations due Friday 8 PM per MOM §2.2.1) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (the workflow below)

Friday evening is the last opportunity to land the meet plan in writing before everyone disperses for the weekend. Walk through three checks in order:

1. Late absences reflected in Meet Maestro. Confirm any absences that arrived after the Wednesday merge are scratched. In Meet Maestro: **Settings → Athletes** or directly from the time entry screen. See Meet Maestro Settings – Athletes.

2. Relay compositions still hold. Teams handle Friday relay management differently:

- **Some teams reseed relays Friday night** based on the absences they have in hand, accepting that Saturday morning may bring a few additional changes. This minimizes Saturday-morning workload but commits to relay compositions that may need touching up.

- **Other teams defer all relay changes to Saturday morning**, working only against the meet-day deadline (1H relays lock 30 minutes before meet start per MOM §1.3.7.4). This avoids re-doing work but concentrates more activity into the morning window.

Both approaches are valid — confirm with your team's Head Coach which one they prefer. Whichever you choose, run the Relay Report Friday evening to identify any relay flagged as incomplete. If your team reseeds Friday, work through them with the Head Coach now. If your team defers to Saturday morning, note the affected relays in your Meet Notes so the morning reseed reviewer knows where to look. Either way, an incomplete relay needs a Head Coach decision: re-seed with an eligible swimmer, swim short as exhibition, or drop entirely.

> 💡 ***Head Coach involvement in relay reseeds varies by team.*** *"Work through them with the Head Coach" is shorthand for two different patterns. Some Head Coaches want to see and approve every relay composition individually — particularly on smaller teams where the coach knows each swimmer's strengths in each stroke. Other Head Coaches operate on a* ***standing agreement****: they specify a reseed methodology up front (e.g., "for free relays, anchor with the fastest 50-free time, then leg 1 next-fastest, then 2 and 3"; "for medley relays, fastest stroke specialist gets each leg subject to availability"), and the Computer Rep applies that methodology on the coach's behalf without per-relay consultation. In standing-agreement mode, the Computer Rep still flags edge cases (incomplete relays, swimmers with restrictions, judgment calls) — but routine reseeds happen without involving the coach in real time. Confirm with your team which mode applies before the season starts, and re-confirm with each new Head Coach. Where this guide says "work through them with the Head Coach" or "Head Coach decision," teams on standing-agreement can read that as "apply the standing methodology and flag exceptions."*

3. Combo plan still holds. Compare your Wednesday-approved combo list against current entries. The default posture here is "leave existing combos in place." For each combo, confirm:

- The combined heat is still workable (a "5 + 1" after Friday scratches still works fine — running a one-swimmer heat as part of a combo is preferable to going back and reseparating)
- No new combo *opportunities* have appeared because of late scratches (small heats that weren't combo candidates Wednesday but now are)

Surface anything you find to the Home Meet Director by Friday 8 PM. New combo additions are usually approved quickly when meet runtime is a concern — they save time. Changes to existing combos only happen when entries have shifted in a way that invalidates the combo's basis (a key heat shrinking, swimmers no longer making sense together, etc.); they don't save time and aren't done for runtime reasons. Outside of those entry-driven cases, leave existing combos alone. Either way, both Meet Directors must agree per §1.4's framework.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Pre-seed the Saturday-morning swimmer attendance form Friday night with everything known so far. Saturday morning becomes "what changed in the last 12 hours" rather than "fill out the whole form from scratch."*

2.2 ⭐ Update Meet Notes with relay restrictions

⭐ **STEINER PRACTICE**

Steiner runs the **Meet Matrix** report in SwimTopia (Manage Team → Reports → Meet Entry Matrix) and reviews it for swimmers with relay restrictions or early-departure notes, then adds a relay restrictions table to the Meet Notes so the morning reseed reviewer can consult it quickly. Example:

Swimmer	Age Group	Restriction
(Name)	9-10	No medley relay; must leave by event 45

This is a Steiner workflow artifact. The underlying need — knowing about relay constraints before reseed time — is universal, but the format and document are Steiner's. Adapt to your team's own coordination style (some teams handle this verbally with the coach, some via Slack/text).

Phase 3 — Meet Day, Pre-Start

3.1 Receive check-ins (≥ 30 minutes before start)

📋 **REQUIRED** (1H relay deadline) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (the 45-minute check-in target)

Per MOM §1.3.7.4, beginning relays (events 1–11) lock 30 minutes before meet start, so all check-ins that affect relays must be processed by then. Most teams aim to receive check-ins ~45 minutes before start to give the Computer Rep time to scratch absentees and reseed relays before the deadline.

The tent parents or Team Coordinator delivers completed check-in sheets to the computer table. Mark each absent swimmer in Meet Maestro: **Settings → Athletes → click swimmer → Scratch Athlete** (or scratch from individual events as needed).

> 💡 ***Tip:*** *"Scratch Athlete" removes the swimmer from all events at once; unchecking individual events removes them one at a time. See Meet Maestro Settings – Athletes.*

3.2 Reseed first-half relays

📋 **REQUIRED** — Per MOM §1.3.7.4, beginning relays (events 1–11) lock 30 minutes before meet start.

The first half of the meet contains medley relays (events 2–11) and the 6&U Mixed Free Relay (event 1). These reseed differently:

Medley relays (events 2–11) are seeded by stroke. The four legs are swum in order — back, breast, fly, free — so each leg has to be filled by a swimmer who can legally swim *that* stroke. The general approach:

1. For each leg (back, breast, fly, free), identify the eligible swimmers.
2. Assign the fastest eligible swimmer in each stroke to that leg.
3. If a swimmer is the fastest in two strokes, assign them to the stroke where their advantage over the next-fastest swimmer is largest.
4. Cross-check against any relay restrictions in your Meet Notes (early departures, no-medley-relay flags, etc.).

Free relay (event 1) is the 6&U Mixed Free Relay. Use the fastest-to-slowest order described in §4.5 for free relays.

> 💡 ***Maestro tip:*** *When you scratch an absent swimmer, Meet Maestro flags incomplete relays with a warning indicator. Click the relay to see which leg is missing and which swimmers are eligible to fill it. You can also reseed a range of events automatically:* ***Settings → Seeding & Scoring → Reseed Range of Events****. Use this carefully — it overrides any manual lane changes you've made, and Meet Maestro's auto-seed for medley relays may not match what your Head Coach wants. Many Computer Reps prefer to reseed medley relays manually. See Athlete Entry / Deck Changes.*

3.3 Process scratches and first-half deck entries

📋 **REQUIRED** (start-of-meet deadline) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (process timing)

Per MOM §1.3.7.4, individual events 12–47 lock at the start of the meet. NWSC rules don't require scratches before that point, but processing them just after relays is more efficient — it lets you print clean first-half heat sheets without the relays included.

> 💡 ***Tip:*** *Save a few last-minute individual events for stragglers if you can — late arrivals are common.*

3.4 🖨️ Print timer sheets and first-half heat sheets

💡 **RECOMMENDED** (production sequence) / ⭐ **Steiner Practice** (specific quantities and file names)

Print **timer sheets first or concurrently** with heat sheets so timers can be briefed at the timer meeting (typically ~25 minutes before meet start). The default workflow assumes Saturday-morning printing once scratches and reseeds are settled.

> 💡 ***Team variation: print in advance.*** *Some teams print non-relay timer sheets and first-half heat sheets the night before (typically Friday afternoon or evening) and handle Saturday-morning scratches verbally rather than re-printing or marking up distributed sheets. This trades up-front time for tolerance of stale paper, and depends on tight communication between the computer table, ready bench, timers, and stroke judges. Relay timer sheets and relay heat sheets are an exception — those always print Saturday morning regardless of approach, since 1H relay reseeds don't happen until the 30-minute pre-meet window (per §3.2). Whether the advance-print approach works is* ***ultimately up to the Meet Directors****. Confirm with the Home Meet Director which approach your meet is using before the morning starts. The rest of §3.4 assumes Saturday-morning printing; teams using advance-print can skip ahead to §3.5 once last-minute additions are noted verbally.*

🖨️ Timer sheets

Run from Meet Maestro Reports → Timer Sheets once Saturday-morning scratches and reseeds are settled. Choose the options that match your timing system (Dolphin, manual stopwatches, or hybrid). Hand off to the Head Timer for distribution to lane timers at the timers meeting.

🖨️ First-half heat sheets — initial distribution

The first heat sheets off the printer should go to the people who need them *before* the meet starts: **Stroke Judges, Exchange Judges, and Ready Bench first**, so they can review at the stroke/exchange judges meeting and ready bench meeting respectively. These officials need to see **every swimmer in each heat — both teams' swimmers, not just yours** — so 🏠 if hosting, print **all-teams versions** for them rather than home-team-only versions.

> 💡 ***Print relay events first, then remaining first-half events.*** *Best practice is to produce the relay-event heat sheets (events 1–11) immediately once 1H relay reseeds are entered, before printing the remaining first-half individual events (12–47). Relays happen at the very start of the meet, and the 30-minute pre-meet window is tight — getting relay sheets to officials and timers as soon as they're ready guarantees the meet can start on time. The remaining 1H individual events have a later lock deadline (start of meet per §1.3.7.4) and can be printed in a second pass while the relay sheets are being distributed and the relay timer sheets are being prepared. This sequence is what most file-naming conventions encode (e.g., the Steiner* `_MR_Only` *and* `_1H_Only` *suffixes — see Steiner Practice below).*
>
> 💡 ***Parallel printing with the visiting team.*** *If the visiting Computer Rep brought a printer and is willing to assist, the two teams can split the print work to compress the pre-meet window further: the home Computer Rep prints the* ***relay timer sheets and relay heat sheets*** *(the time-critical items that need to be ready 30 minutes before meet start), while the visiting Computer Rep prints* ***the full first-half heat sheets*** *(events 1–47) on their own printer. The home team distributes the relay sheets immediately to officials and timers; the visiting team's full 1H sheets become available shortly after for the next priority tier (coaches, coordinators, scorers, tent parents). This requires both Computer Reps to have a copy of the same merged Meet Maestro database — which the visiting Rep already has from the Wednesday-night merge per §1.4 — plus any Saturday-morning scratches communicated verbally between the two computer tables. Confirm with the home Computer Rep at meet setup whether you'll split the work; this is a coordination decision, not a default. The home team is still ultimately responsible for the official timer sheets and for any combined-heats annotations.*
>
> 💡 ***Two axes to keep straight when printing heat sheets:***

1. **Roster scope:** *home-team only* (just your swimmers) vs *all teams* (every swimmer in every heat). Officials and ready bench need *all teams*. Coaches typically just need their own.
2. **Schedule scope:** *first half only*, *second half only*, *relays only*, or *full schedule* (the entire meet from event 1 to 87).

> *The two axes combine — a Stroke Judge at a home meet typically wants "all teams + full schedule," while a coach reviewing morning relays might want "home-team only + medley relays only." Most file-naming conventions encode both axes (see Steiner Practice below).*

After Stroke Judges, Exchange Judges, and Ready Bench have their copies, distribute to other parties in roughly this order:

- Coaches (each one needs a copy — usually home-team only)
- Meet & Team Coordinators
- Scorers
- Tent parents (if your team uses a basic-format single-sided check-in style sheet)

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice — distribution:*** *~8 coach copies, 2 each for meet/team coordinators, scorers, ready bench, stroke judges, and exchange judges. Roughly 15+ total to start. Tent parents get a separate single-sided basic-format print.*

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice — file naming:*** *`HS_*` files contain Steiner swimmers only; `HSF_*` files (the F is for "full roster") contain swimmers from all teams. The suffix indicates schedule scope: `_MR_Only` (medley relays only), `_FR_Only` (free relays only), `_1H_Only` (first half), `_2H_Only` (second half), `_FM` (full meet — the entire schedule from event 1 to 87). So `HSF_FM.pdf` means "all teams, full schedule" and `HS_1H_Only.pdf` means "Steiner only, first half only." Use whatever your team has standardized.*

3.5 🏠 Home-only pre-start tasks

These run in parallel with the printing in §3.4. The Dolphin timing system check should be done *first* (or at the start of the morning) since it's the earliest dependency: if Dolphin isn't talking to Meet Maestro, the meet can't start.

💡 Dolphin timing system check (first thing — if applicable)

If your facility uses the CTS Dolphin Wireless Timing System, complete its setup and verification at the **start of the morning**, before timer sheets and heat sheets are printed:

1. Connect the Dolphin base unit to the meet computer via USB and open the Dolphin software.
2. Confirm Meet Maestro and Dolphin are pointed at the same data directory.
3. Verify on the Dolphin **Signals** screen that all watches and the starter are connected, on the same channel, and have ≥ 50% battery. Replace any battery below 50% before the meet starts.
4. Run a test heat (any event) to confirm times flow from Dolphin into Meet Maestro on Reset.

For full setup, hardware configuration, and troubleshooting, see **Appendix A — CTS Dolphin Wireless Timing System** at the end of this guide.

🖨️ Combined heats sheets — 💡 RECOMMENDED (when applicable)

If any heats are combined, print copies of the combined-heat reference for officials before the timer and stroke/exchange meetings. Meet Maestro's run interface and heat sheets do **not** visually reflect combined heats — admins must annotate the printed sheets and notify the ready bench, timers, and judges directly.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *~10 copies of a per-meet combined heats reference document.*

🖨️ DQ codes sheet — 💡 RECOMMENDED

Print copies of the 2019 USA Swimming DQ Codes sheet for the scorers. This is less time-sensitive than the items above — it can be printed any time before scoring starts (typically a few minutes after event 1 finishes). Meet Maestro uses these codes by default. See Meet Maestro – Results Entry and Actions for DQ entry details.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *4 two-sided copies. Adjust to your scorers' needs.*

Phase 4 — Running the Meet

4.1 Data entry and validation (ongoing)

📋 **REQUIRED** (recording official times per MOM §1.3.7.3) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (the specific Meet Maestro workflow below)

Throughout the meet, enter results from the scorers' lane sheets (or auto-import from your timing system) into Meet Maestro.

Key behaviors of the time entry interface:

- **Heat color coding:** green = complete, yellow = incomplete, blue = not yet started. Yellow is your scan target — events showing yellow have at least one missing time.
- **Three timer fields by default.** The "official time" calculation follows your league's seeding & scoring rules. With three watches, the typical league rule is "middle of three" or "average if any one is more than 1 second off the others." You can toggle timer field visibility with the `><` icon in the time entry header.
- **Out-of-tolerance warnings.** If timer values disagree, Meet Maestro will either display a warning (yellow background) or auto-discard the outlier (grey background), depending on your meet template. Review and adjust as needed.

> 📋 ***Required (MOM §5.10):*** *When manual stopwatches are used, the* ***middle of three*** *times is the official time. If two times are identical, that is official. If one time is ≥ 1.0 seconds higher or lower than the other two, it's discarded and the remaining two are averaged to one hundredth of a second with no rounding. Verify your Meet Maestro template implements this.*

🖊️ **Manual time entry workflow** (when watches are used as the primary timing method, or as backup when Dolphin fails for a heat):

1. Open the event in Meet Maestro and click into the heat.
2. For each lane, enter the three timer values into the timer fields (T1, T2, T3 by default).
3. Meet Maestro applies the league's official-time rule automatically — if all three watches agree within 1.0 second, the middle value becomes official; if one is more than 1 second off, it's discarded and the remaining two are averaged.
4. The "official time" cell shows the calculated result. Verify it matches what the lane timer sheet shows the head timer signed off on. If there's a discrepancy, check whether one of the timer values was entered incorrectly.
5. If you need to override the calculated time (e.g., the timers later determine that one watch malfunctioned and should be excluded), use the **Time Adjustment Form** rather than directly overwriting the raw timer values. The Time Adjustment Form preserves the original timer values for audit and applies an explicit adjustment that's flagged in the meet log.

Time Adjustment Form is accessed by clicking the time cell and selecting "Adjust" from the menu. Fields:

- Adjusted time (the new official time)
- Reason (free text — record what was learned, e.g., "T2 watch failed mid-race per head timer")
- Approver (typically the Lead Scorer or Head Timer)

Reference: [Meet Maestro – Results Entry Interface Overview]().

4.2 Mid-meet exception handling

📋 **REQUIRED** (per MOM §1.3.7.4 deadlines) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (the workflows below)

A real meet generates exceptions that aren't on the heat sheet. This section covers the most common situations and what's allowed under the MOM.

Coach-requested deck adds

A coach approaches the computer table mid-meet and asks to add a swimmer to an event. **What's allowed depends on whether the event's deadline has passed** (per MOM §1.3.7.4):

Event type	Lock deadline	What you can do after the deadline
Beginning relays (1–11)	30 min before meet start	Nothing — relay reseeds are closed; the relay swims as previously seeded
First-half individual events (12–47)	Start of meet	Nothing — the event is locked; coach can request the swimmer for second-half events instead
Second-half individual events (48–77)	Start of event 24	Nothing — second-half individual events are locked at event 24
Ending relays (78–87)	Start of event 58	Nothing — relay reseeds are closed

Before the deadline: add the swimmer in Meet Maestro via **Settings → Athletes → click swimmer → toggle event participation**, or directly from the heat-edit screen. Confirm the change with the coach by repeating it back ("adding Sarah Chen to event 32, agreed?") before clicking save.

After the deadline: politely decline. The MOM is explicit, and the deadline exists so officials and timers can prepare. If the coach pushes, escalate to the Home Meet Director — they have the authority to grant rare exceptions but the Computer Rep should not make this call independently.

> 💡 ***Verification protocol for any mid-meet change.*** *When a coach hands you a note or makes a verbal request: read the change back to them, ideally with the Meet Maestro UI visible so they can see what you're about to do. Save only after they confirm. This is the lowest-cost way to prevent miscommunication-driven errors that are hard to undo.*

Late-arriving swimmers (un-scratching)

A swimmer was scratched Saturday morning but arrived after the meet started:

1. **Check the deadlines.** The same MOM §1.3.7.4 deadlines apply — if the swimmer's events have all locked, there's nothing to add them to.
2. **For events still open:** in Meet Maestro, **Settings → Athletes → click swimmer → "Scratch Athlete"** is a toggle. Click again to un-scratch.
3. **Reseed the heat if necessary.** If the swimmer's lane was reassigned during the morning's reseed, you may need to swap them back. Coordinate with the head coach on whether the reseed gets reverted or whether the swimmer takes whatever lane is available.
4. **Notify the ready bench, stroke judges, and lane timers.** Verbally — there's no automatic notification. Walk the change to the relevant officials so the heat doesn't run with an empty lane that the swimmer is supposed to be in.

Swimmer in wrong lane (caught before the heat starts)

If the ready bench or a stroke judge flags that a swimmer is in the wrong lane just before the heat:

1. **Decide whether to fix in Maestro or just on deck.** If the swimmer is one lane off (lane 3 instead of lane 4), the official-finish-time recording will be wrong unless either the lane sheet is corrected or the Maestro lane assignment is updated. Most often, the easier fix is to swap the lane assignments in Maestro before the heat runs and let the swimmers stay where they're already standing.
2. **Use Meet Maestro's lane swap.** Click into the heat, then drag a swimmer to a different lane (or use the right-click menu to swap). The seed times and event assignments stay with the swimmer; only the lane assignment changes.
3. **Re-print only if necessary.** If a stroke judge or timer needs a corrected sheet, re-print just that heat's slip. For most lane swaps, a verbal heads-up to the timer for the affected lanes is sufficient.

Heat re-runs (false start with DQ, equipment failure, etc.)

When a heat needs to re-run for any reason:

1. **Confirm with the Starter and the Home Meet Director** that the re-run is happening — this is not the Computer Rep's call.
2. **Do not delete or overwrite the original times** if any were captured. Meet Maestro keeps the times in the original heat record; if a re-run is decided, the official times come from the re-run, but the original times remain in the audit trail.
3. **For Dolphin-timed re-runs:** Dolphin will treat the re-run as a new race, generating a new race file. After the re-run, in Meet Maestro's Dolphin timing bar, **edit the Race # to point at the re-run's race file** rather than the original. Times from the re-run will then load when you click "Reset and Load."
4. **For manually-timed re-runs:** enter the new times via the regular time entry workflow. If the original times are still showing, click each timer field and replace.
5. **DQ from the original heat carries over only if it was a stroke/exchange DQ.** False-start DQs apply only to the swimmer who second-false-started in the original heat; for re-run participants, the slate is clean. Confirm with the Starter on which DQ codes apply.

Times loaded into the wrong race (Dolphin combined heats)

When two heats share a Dolphin race file (combined heats), Meet Maestro will offer to load the times into either heat. If you click load on the wrong heat first, the times go into the wrong place.

Recovery:

1. In the Dolphin timing bar, click into the time entry of the heat that received the wrong times.
2. Use the Time Adjustment Form on each affected lane to clear out the incorrect times (set to "No Time" with a note).
3. Then reload the race into the correct heat — Meet Maestro will warn that data exists for empty lanes, which is expected for combined heats.

Sticky-note / verbal coach requests during the meet

Coaches often pass written notes or verbal messages to the computer table mid-meet — relay swimmer swaps, scratches, late additions, lane changes, "swap lanes 3 and 6 for the next heat," etc. The verification pattern that prevents the most errors:

1. **Repeat back what you heard,** ideally pointing at the Meet Maestro UI showing the change you're about to make.
2. **Wait for an explicit confirmation** ("yes, do that") before clicking save.
3. **Document the change in your Meet Notes** (or your team's equivalent) — a note like "Event 32 Heat 2: swapped lane 3 and lane 6 per [coach name]'s request, 10:42 AM" prevents downstream confusion if the swap is questioned later.
4. **For changes affecting officials or timers,** notify them verbally before the next affected heat starts.

4.3 Entering DQs

📋 **REQUIRED** (processing DQ slips per MOM §1.3.7.3 #6) / 💡 **RECOMMENDED** (the Meet Maestro workflow)

When a DQ slip arrives at the scoring table:

1. Open the relevant event/heat in Meet Maestro.
2. Click the **DQ checkbox** in the swimmer's lane.
3. Select the appropriate **DQ code** from the dropdown (Meet Maestro uses 2019 USA Swimming DQ codes).
4. For multi-leg events (relays, IM), if you select a leg-specific stroke infraction, you'll be prompted for the leg number and a secondary DQ reason.
5. Hover over the DQ checkbox or DQ code at any time to see the full list of selected reasons.

💡 **Workflow:**

- DQ slips for each team should be kept separate.
- 📋 Per MOM §1.3.8.2 #4, the Head Coach uses DQ slips to educate swimmers on stroke improvement. Hand the home team's DQ slips to the home Head Coach at the end of the meet, and the visiting team's slips to the visiting Head Coach.

4.4 Combined heats during data entry

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

If you set up combined heats by splitting lanes (e.g., heat 1 in lanes 1–3, heat 2 in lanes 4–6 of the same actual swim), enter times normally — Meet Maestro will score them as separate heats. If you're using a Dolphin timing system, both heats can pull from the same race file; Meet Maestro will warn you that times exist in "empty" lanes, which is expected.

4.5 Reseed second-half relays

📋 **REQUIRED** — Per MOM §1.3.7.4, ending relays (events 78–87) lock at the start of event 58 (long freestyle).

💡 **Recommended:** Get this done by the start of event 24 (the second-half individual deadline) — that gives the Head Coach time to consult with swimmers and finalize relay compositions, and gives the Computer Rep time to enter the changes without a last-minute scramble.

The second half contains the freestyle relays (events 78–87). All four legs are freestyle, so any eligible swimmer can fill any leg. The general approach is **fastest-to-slowest by leg position** — assign the strongest available swimmer to the position where they'll have the most impact:

1. **Fourth leg (anchor):** fastest swimmer.
2. **First leg (lead-off):** next fastest. Lead-off times are also recorded as official 50-yard or 100-yard splits, so a strong leg-1 also produces a useful individual time on the books.
3. **Second leg:** third-fastest.
4. **Third leg:** fourth-fastest.

Process:

1. Confirm all absent swimmers have been scratched. Meet Maestro will flag incomplete relays automatically.
2. For each flagged relay, click into it, identify the missing leg, and add the appropriate swimmer using the leg order above.
3. Cross-check any relay restrictions.

4.6 🏠 🖨️ Print award labels (during the meet)

💡 **RECOMMENDED** (printing labels) / ⭐ **Steiner Practice** (specific batch cut-points)

Per MOM §1.3.12.3, the Lead Scorer organizes processed results so awards can be distributed. Most teams print labels in batches as scoring catches up. Use **Avery 5160** (or compatible) labels, single-sided. Confirm the printer is set to single-sided if it was used for two-sided printing earlier.

In Meet Maestro: **Reports → Awards Labels**, select the event range, choose Avery 5160, and verify excluded places with your Team Coordinator before printing.

> ⭐ *Steiner Practice — batch cut-points:*

- After event 11
- After event 23
- After event 31
- After event 45
- After event 59
- After event 69
- After event 81
- After event 87 (or end of meet)

> *Other teams use different cadences. Coordinate with your Team Coordinator and ribbons team on what works best for your meet flow.*

4.7 🖨️ Print second-half heat sheets

💡 **RECOMMENDED** (production) / ⭐ **Steiner Practice** (target timing and file naming)

Print second-half heat sheets for coaches, scorers, and other on-deck consumers, and save PDFs.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Target completion by event 24 (so they're ready before the second-half stroke transition). File naming mirrors first-half conventions:* `HS_FR_Only.pdf`, `HS_2H_Only.pdf`, `HS_FM.pdf`, `HSF_FR_Only.pdf`, `HSF_2H_Only.pdf`, `HSF_FM.pdf`.

🏠 If hosting, again include all-teams versions for ready bench, stroke, and exchange judges.

4.8 🖨️ Print time-improvement labels

⭐ **STEINER PRACTICE**

Steiner prints time-improvement labels in two batches:

- After event 45: improvement labels covering events 12–45 (first half)
- After event 81: improvement labels covering events 46–81 (second half)

Use Avery 5160, single-sided.

This is a team-level award practice and is not part of the NWSC meet requirements. Other teams may not print improvement labels at all, may print them at different intervals, or may handle them post-meet.

4.9 🖨️ Print record-breaker labels (during meet)

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

Use Meet Maestro's **Record Breaker Labels** report. This is a post-meet report that updates as records are broken — it's distinct from the static "Records" report (which only reflects records as they existed at merge time).

Provide labels to the Team Coordinator and announcer so records can be celebrated as they happen.

Reference: Benchmarks (Records & Time Standards).

4.10 🏠 Publish meet results

📋 **REQUIRED** — Per MOM §1.3.7.3 #8 / §2.4 final scoring.

After the final event is scored and both Meet Directors confirm readiness, publish the final results in Meet Maestro.

Phase 5 — Post-Meet

5.1 🖨️ Print participation ribbons

💡 **RECOMMENDED** (the practice) / ⭐ **Steiner Practice** (specific age-group selections)

Many circuit teams print participation ribbons for younger age groups using Meet Maestro's per-swimmer (not per-event) format introduced in the 2024 season. Print these before leaving the meet so the ribbons team can distribute or prepare them.

Confirm the age groups and excluded places with your Team Coordinator.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Steiner prints participation ribbons for 6 & Unders and 7-8s, one per swimmer for the meet. Other teams may include different age groups or skip participation ribbons entirely.*

5.2 Save and share final meet results

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

1. Run the **Meet Results** report from Meet Maestro.
2. Save the PDF to your team's meet archive.
3. Email the PDF (or a link) to the Team Coordinator for posting on the team website.

Confirm with the Team Coordinator whether to include heat place — this has caused confusion in the past, so default to following their preference.

> ⭐ ***Steiner Practice:*** *Save as* `YYYYMMDD - HOME vs OPP - Meet Results.pdf` *in the team meet archive folder.*

5.3 🏠 Lock and transfer results

📋 **REQUIRED** — Per MOM §1.3.7.3 #4, the Home Computer Rep is responsible for ensuring final data is entered correctly into the meet database. Per #8/#9, results are then provided to the Visiting Computer Rep and retained by the home team.

Once you're satisfied that all data entry is correct:

1. Go to **Settings → Finish & Export** in Meet Maestro.
2. Confirm there are no incomplete events.
3. Click **Lock Meet**. After locking, no further changes can be made in Meet Maestro.
4. Click **Transfer Results**. The home team is responsible for transferring; results flow into every linked SwimTopia site automatically.

Transfer takes about a minute. Results land in:

- Each team's Results tab on their meet page
- Athlete Performance reports
- Family "My Account" time histories
- The SwimTopia mobile app

> 💡 ***Important:*** *If you click Transfer Results a second time, all results in every team's SwimTopia site are overwritten with the current Meet Maestro state — including any edits a team may have made on their SwimTopia side. Coordinate before re-transferring.*

Reference: Meet Maestro Settings – Finish & Export.

5.4 Update record books in SwimTopia

💡 **RECOMMENDED**

After results are transferred, update your team's record books in SwimTopia:

1. In SwimTopia, navigate to **Manage Team → Records** (or wherever your team's record books live).
2. Click **Find New Records to Import**.

3. Filter to the most recent meet(s).
4. Review each candidate record and confirm whether to add. Records that look right but stem from data anomalies (timing system glitches, course-correction edge cases) should be flagged with the Head Coach before adding.

Reference Card — Standard Event Numbers

📋 **REQUIRED (MOM Appendix C, 2026 ordering)**

The standard NWSC dual format is 87 events. Female events are even-numbered except event 1 (mixed). The 2025 season used a transitional 91-event ordering with duplicate 11-12 Breast and 11-12 Fly entries (Appendix C1); for 2026 those duplicates drop and the totals return to 87.

Events	Description
1	6 & Under Mixed Free Relay
2–11	Medley Relays (7-8 through 15-17)
12–23	Short Freestyle
24–31	Individual Medley
32–45	Backstroke + 6&U Butterfly
46–57	Breaststroke (7-8 / 9-10 / 6&U at 25 Yd; 11-12 / 13-14 / 15-17 at 50 Yd)
58–67	Long Freestyle (7-8 / 9-10 at 50 Yd; 11-12 / 13-14 / 15-17 at 100 Yd)
68–77	Butterfly (7-8 / 9-10 at 25 Yd; 11-12 / 13-14 / 15-17 at 50 Yd)
78–87	Free Relays

The deadline boundaries (events 24 and 58) align with stroke-group transitions, which is why those points come up repeatedly in the workflow above.

> ***One subtle change vs. 2024.*** *The 6&U Breaststroke event sits between the 9-10 and 11-12 Breast entries (events 50–51 in the 2026 ordering) instead of leading the breast block at events 46–47 as it did in pre-2025 seasons. Heat sheets should still print correctly from Meet Maestro using the standard NWSC template, but Computer Reps comparing this season's heat sheets against archived 2024 sheets will notice the 6&U Breast appearing later in the breast block.*

Reference Card — Official Time Computation (Manual Timing)

📋 **REQUIRED (MOM §5.10)**

When manual stopwatches are used:

- **Three valid times:** the **middle** time is official.
- **Two identical times:** that time is official.

- **One outlier (≥ 1.0 second from the other two):** discard it; the remaining two are averaged to one hundredth of a second with no rounding.

Meet Maestro's seeding & scoring rules implement this automatically when configured correctly. Verify your league's rule is set in the Meet Template before the meet starts.

Common Issues and Quick Fixes

💡 **RECOMMENDED** — Troubleshooting tips, not requirements.

"An athlete on the roster isn't appearing in Meet Maestro."

If they were on the roster at merge time, check **Settings → Athletes** — they may show as Unavailable rather than missing. You can flip them to Available without scratching events.

If they were added after the merge, you can deck-add them in **Settings → Athletes → Add Athlete**. Use sparingly: athletes added directly to a meet bypass the SwimTopia waiver flow, and duplicates can occur when results transfer back. Reference: Meet Maestro Settings – Athletes.

"I need to combine two heats but the heat sheet doesn't show it."

Move athletes/relays from one heat into open lanes in the adjacent heat (lanes 1–3 vs 4–6, for example). Meet Maestro scores them as separate heats. Annotate printed heat sheets manually and brief the ready bench, timers, and judges. Some teams use a 0-minute scheduled break between the two events as a visual marker on heat sheets.

"I scratched a swimmer but their relay isn't showing as incomplete."

Refresh the page. If the warning still doesn't appear, open the relay directly — the missing leg should be flagged in red. If not, the swimmer may still be assigned to that specific relay even after individual scratches; remove them from the relay manually.

"The visiting team's roster has wrong info for an athlete."

Edit the athlete in **Settings → Athletes → Edit Athlete**. Changes only apply to the current meet — they will not flow back to SwimTopia. Permanent corrections must be made in the team's SwimTopia account.

"Times for the wrong race loaded from the timing system."

For combined heats with a single Dolphin race file, edit the **Race Number** field in the timing system bar to match the saved race number. Times will populate; messages about "loaded data for empty lanes" are expected and can be ignored or cleared.

"The meet template is locked and I need to change a scoring rule."

Locked templates are typically set by the league. The seeding & scoring screen in Meet Maestro will be read-only. Contact the league admin to unlock the template; the screen unlocks dynamically once the league change saves.

"Wi-Fi dropped at the host pool."

Meet Maestro is browser-based but supports offline operation for the in-progress meet — once the meet is open in your browser, you can continue entering times, scratches, and DQs without an active connection. Changes are queued locally and sync back when connectivity returns. **Do not close the browser tab** while offline; closing forces a reload that requires connectivity. If the connection returns, refresh the page only after confirming sync (a sync indicator appears at the top of the screen). If publishing results requires network access, hold the publish step until connectivity is back; data entry can continue meanwhile.

"Meet Maestro stopped responding mid-meet."

Most often this is browser-state, not data loss. **Before doing anything else,** open Meet Maestro in a new tab — recent changes typically appear there once the new tab loads. If they don't:

1. Hard-refresh the original tab (Ctrl+Shift+R or Cmd+Shift+R). Meet Maestro auto-saves on every change, so unsaved-data loss is rare.
2. If a hard refresh doesn't recover, close the tab and reopen the meet from your team's SwimTopia site. The meet's state (entries, times entered, scratches) persists in the cloud.
3. If the meet itself appears corrupted or incomplete after recovery, contact SwimTopia support — they can roll back to a recent auto-save. This is rare but exists as a backstop.

"Power outage forced a meet delay."

The MOM (§2.4.8) gives the Home Meet Director authority to delay or cancel the meet under inclement-weather and facility-issue conditions; power outages typically fall under the latter. While the delay is in effect:

1. **Don't power-cycle the Computer Rep's laptop** unnecessarily — battery time is a finite resource. Close non-essential applications.
2. **Do not abandon the Meet Maestro session.** Once power returns, your browser tab will pick up where you left off as long as the laptop didn't fully discharge.
3. **For a long delay,** consider connecting to a phone hotspot for connectivity if the pool's WiFi is also down. Meet Maestro's bandwidth needs are minimal.

"Visiting team can't deliver their database by Tuesday midnight."

Per MOM §2.2.1, the deadline is firm. If the visiting team is going to miss it:

1. The visiting Computer Rep should notify the home Computer Rep and Meet Director **before** the deadline, not after.
2. The home Meet Director and visiting Meet Director should agree on a revised deadline that still preserves the Wednesday midnight merged-database deadline (which is downstream of the visiting deadline).
3. If the visiting team can't deliver in time for a Wednesday merge, the meet may need to be conducted with the visiting team's earlier database — meaning the visiting team accepts whatever entries were finalized before the issue. The Computer Rep should not unilaterally accept a late database; this is a Meet Director call.

"The Wednesday merge produced unexpected errors."

If Build Meet in Meet Maestro fails or produces obvious problems (missing swimmers, wrong age groups, duplicate athletes):

1. **Don't immediately re-run the merge.** Note exactly what error or symptom you saw.
2. Verify both teams marked Ready in SwimTopia — if either status is not Ready, the merge will not include that team's entries.
3. Check **Settings → Athletes** filtered by team to see whether the merge included entries from each team correctly.
4. If a problem is isolated to a small number of athletes, you can deck-add the missing entries via **Settings → Athletes → Add Athlete**.
5. If the merge is broadly wrong, contact SwimTopia support — they can advise on whether to re-run or roll back. Avoid making major manual corrections that may conflict with a re-run.

Appendix A — CTS Dolphin Wireless Timing System

The CTS Dolphin is a wireless stopwatch system used by many NWSC pools as either the primary timing system or a backup to a touchpad/button system. This appendix covers setup, the three on-deck roles (Computer Operator, Starting Official, Lane Timer), Meet Maestro integration, and common troubleshooting.

> *Most of this material is **vendor mechanics** (how the equipment works) and is not tagged. Items that intersect with NWSC/MOM requirements — primarily what counts as a valid official time — are tagged 📋.*

A.1 What's in the system

A complete Dolphin system has four components:

- **Dolphin Software** — runs on a Windows computer (Windows 7 64-bit or later). The software receives wireless data from the base and writes result files to a folder on the computer.
- **Wireless Stopwatches** — one per lane timer (typically 1–3 watches per lane, labeled A/B/C). Each watch is assigned a lane and timer position via a button-menu on the watch itself.
- **Dolphin Starter** (optional) — a wireless device that starts all watches simultaneously. Can be used standalone, or connected via cable to an electronic start system (CTS Infinity, Championship Start, etc.) so the start signal triggers the watches automatically.
- **Base Unit** — connects to the computer via USB and receives wireless signals from the watches and starter.

Each component except the base runs on a 9V battery.

A.2 Three operating modes

Choose the mode your facility uses; the rest of the appendix references back to these.

Mode 1 — Wireless Manual Start/Stop. Watches are used like standard stopwatches: each Lane Timer presses Start at the start signal and Stop at the finish. The starter is not used. This satisfies all major sanctioning bodies' requirements for backup timing.

Mode 2 — Synchronized Start / Manual Stop. The Starting Official starts all watches simultaneously by pressing Start on the Dolphin Starter at the same moment as the meet's start signal. Lane Timers stop them individually at the finish.

Mode 3 — Electronic Start System. The Dolphin Starter is cabled to the facility's electronic start system (Infinity Pro, Championship Start, Championship Elite, etc.). When the Starting Official starts the race using the electronic start system, the watches start automatically. Lane Timers stop them individually at the finish.

📋 **Either mode can produce official times under MOM §5.10**, since manual stopwatch timing is the recognized fallback. With three watches per lane, the standard middle-of-three rule applies; with two watches, the average; with one outlier ≥ 1.0 second from the others, discard and average the remaining two.

A.3 Initial setup (first time / pre-season)

This is a one-time setup per timing computer. After it's done, day-of setup is much shorter (see A.4).

1. **Install meet management software first** (Meet Maestro Desktop application, since the web app does not support timing system integration). Download from `https://swimtopia.com/downloads/maestro/latest`. The desktop app is required for Dolphin integration.
2. **Install Dolphin software.** Download from `https://www.coloradotime.com/dolphindownload/`. **Do not connect the base unit until after the software is installed.** The default install location creates `C:\CTSDolphin\` with `DOCS` and `Firmware` subfolders.
3. **Update firmware.** Open the Dolphin software with the base connected and verify firmware versions. As of late 2024, recommended minimums are:

- Watches and Base: 1.51 or higher
- Starter: 1.31 or higher

Firmware updates are in `C:\CTSDolphin\Firmware\` after installation. See the User Guide F912 (Dolphin Device Updates section) for the procedure.

4. **Practice with the system before your first meet.** This cannot be overstated. CTS, SwimTopia, and the volunteer community all emphasize the same point: do a full test run, ideally days or weeks before a real meet, when support lines are open.

A.4 Meet-day setup sequence

> ⚠️ ***Critical order:*** *Set up Meet Maestro **first**, then Dolphin. Meet Maestro writes the events file when the data directory is selected, and Dolphin only looks for the events file when its data directory is selected. If Dolphin is configured first, it won't see the events.*

A.4.1 Meet Maestro side

1. Open the **Meet Maestro Desktop app** on the timing computer and open your meet.
2. Go to **Settings (gear icon) → Timing Setup**.
3. Select **CTS Dolphin** as the timing system.
4. Click **Choose** to set the **data directory**. A common pattern is `C:\CTSDolphin\<season>\<meet-date-and-name>\` so each meet has its own folder. This same folder must be selected in the Dolphin software in step A.4.2.
5. Set the **number of watches** per lane (typically 3 in NWSC dual meets).
6. Optionally check **"Display warnings if fewer watches are imported"** so Maestro flags lanes with missing backup times.
7. Save.

At this point, Meet Maestro writes an `event_settings_v01.csv` file into the data directory describing every event in the meet.

A.4.2 Dolphin software side

1. With the base unit connected to the computer via USB, open the **Dolphin software**.
2. Click **Settings** at the bottom of the window.
3. Under **Logging**, click **Browse** and select the **same data directory** you chose in Meet Maestro.

4. Confirm at least **CSV format** is checked under logging file types. (Other formats are fine; only CSV is required by Meet Maestro.)
5. Verify the **Channel** under Base — note the number; you'll need to match it on the watches and starter.
6. Note the **Meet #** displayed — this is auto-assigned each time the software opens. Write it down. Every closure-and-reopen of the Dolphin software increments this number.

> 💡 ***Tip:*** *Do **not** click the "Meet #" label unless you intend to change meet numbers. Left-click increments it; right-click decrements. Accidental clicks here are a common cause of lost data.*

A.4.3 Hardware setup — Starter (Modes 2 and 3 only)

1. Turn the starter on by pressing and holding **Reset**.
2. Enter the menu by pressing and holding both buttons until the menu appears.
3. **Mode 3 (electronic start system) only:** First setting is **TRIG**. Press Start/Stop to choose:

- `TRIG = CTS` for use with a CTS electronic start system
- `TRIG = NC` for use with a normally-closed electronic start system

4. Press Reset to advance to **CHAN**. Press Start/Stop to set the channel to match the base.
5. Press Reset to exit the menu.
6. **Mode 3 only:** Connect the starter to the electronic start system's **Start Output** or **Timer Start** jack only. *Connecting to any other jack will damage the starter.*

A.4.4 Hardware setup — Watches

For each watch:

1. Turn on by pressing and holding **Reset**.
2. Enter the menu by pressing and holding **Reset and either side button**.
3. **LANE** — press a side button to set the lane number this watch will time. Press Reset to advance.
4. **TIMER** — press a side button to select A, B, or C (which timer position in the lane). Press Reset to advance.
5. **MAN** — manual start setting. **Set to OFF** for Modes 2 and 3 (so the watch only accepts the synchronized start). **Set to ON** for Mode 1 (Wireless Manual Start/Stop). Press Reset to advance.
6. **CHAN** — must match the base channel and (if used) the starter channel. Press a side button to set. Press Reset to exit.

> 💡 ***Tip:*** *A common labeling scheme: each watch is physically labeled with its assigned lane and timer position (e.g., "L4-B"). This prevents confusion when watches are handed out at the timer's meeting and makes it obvious if a watch winds up in the wrong lane.*

A.4.5 Verify

Open the Dolphin **Signals** screen. You should see every watch and (if used) the starter listed, with adequate signal strength and battery. **Replace any battery below 50% before the meet starts.**

In Meet Maestro's CTS Dolphin timing bar (visible in the time entry interface), you should see **Connected** in the upper right and the **Meet #** box should be green. If the box is not green, the data directories don't match — go back and verify.

Run a test heat (any event, any watches) to confirm:

- Watches start correctly (synchronized in Modes 2/3, individually in Mode 1)

- Lane timers can stop them
- The Dolphin Live screen shows yellow lights when watches are reset
- Meet Maestro's "Load Times" button activates after Reset
- Loading times into Meet Maestro produces sensible results

If anything fails, fix it now — debugging a timing system mid-meet is much harder than debugging it during testing.

A.5 Roles during the meet

A.5.1 Computer Operator (Computer Rep)

Once the system is set up, the Computer Rep's job during the meet is mostly monitoring and importing.

Before each event:

- Confirm the Dolphin Live screen shows the correct event/heat number. Dolphin can auto-increment based on the events file; if not, use hotkeys `N` (next event), `P` (previous event), `H` (next heat), `G` (previous heat).
- Confirm watches show yellow lights (reset state) on the Live screen.

During the heat: mostly hands-off. Watch the Live screen for any anomalies.

After each heat:

- The Starting Official (Modes 2/3) or all Lane Timers (Mode 1) press Reset. This is the trigger that **writes the result file**. Until Reset is pressed, no times are saved.
- In Meet Maestro, the **Load Times** button on the CTS Dolphin timing bar will turn from gray "Not Ready" to orange **Load Times** when a matching race file appears.
- Click **Load Times**. Times populate the lanes for the current event/heat.
- Verify the times look reasonable. If something is off (wrong race loaded, missing watch, etc.), see A.7 troubleshooting.
- Move to the next heat. Race # auto-increments.

Forced reset: If a Lane Timer or Starting Official forgets to press Reset and the next race is about to start, use the Reset button (or shortcut `R`) in the bottom-right of the Dolphin software. **Make sure the race is actually finished first** — forcing a reset while a watch is still running produces no final time for that watch.

> 💡 ***Critical: Do not close the Dolphin software window during the meet.*** *Wireless data is not saved if the window is closed. Minimizing is fine.*

A.5.2 Starting Official

The Starting Official's role depends on which mode you're using.

Mode 1 — Wireless Manual Start/Stop: No Dolphin starter involvement. The Starting Official starts the race normally (whistle, horn, or strobe-equipped system) and Lane Timers handle their watches individually.

Mode 2 — Synchronized Start / Manual Stop:

1. Press **Start/Stop on the Dolphin Starter at the same moment** as the start signal for the swimmers. The starter wirelessly starts every watch.

2. After the last swimmer touches, press **Start/Stop** on the Starter (this is a no-op for results but signals end-of-race), then **Reset**. Reset writes the result file.

Mode 3 — Electronic Start System:

1. Use the electronic start system normally to start the race. The starter cable carries the impulse to the Dolphin Starter, which wirelessly starts the watches.
2. After the race, press **Start/Stop** then **Reset** on the Dolphin Starter. Reset writes the result file.

In Modes 2 and 3, **Lane Timers should NOT press Reset** — only the Starting Official does.

A.5.3 Lane Timer

Each Lane Timer is responsible for one watch (or sometimes two if the team is short-handed). The training depends on the mode:

Mode 1 — Wireless Manual Start/Stop:

1. Press either side button (Start/Stop) at the start signal.
2. Press either side button again when the swimmer in your lane touches the wall.
3. **Splits (if requested):** Press a side button once for each split (per lap, typically). The watch shows the split time for ~2 seconds, then resumes showing running time.
4. After the swimmer finishes, press **Reset**. The watch displays "RESET" alternating with the time. The watch icon disappears from the top row.

Modes 2 / 3 — Synchronized Start:

1. The starter starts all watches automatically. **Do not press anything at the start.**
2. Press either side button when your swimmer touches the wall.
3. Splits work the same as Mode 1.
4. **Do NOT press Reset.** The Starting Official resets all watches together. (Pressing Reset on your watch creates an extra file and can confuse the system.)

Blanking a lane (no swimmer present):

- Mode 1: Press Start/Stop, then Reset. Watch shows dashes.
- Modes 2/3: After the start, press Reset. Watch shows dashes.

If you accidentally blank: press Start/Stop to resume timing. The watch is still accurate as long as you haven't pressed Reset a second time.

Common mistakes:

- Taking too many splits (more than the event calls for) — the watch keeps running, but the screen gets stuck on the last split. Press a side button to resume showing running time.
- Forgetting to Reset (Mode 1) — the result file isn't written. The Computer Rep can force a reset.
- Pressing Reset in Modes 2/3 — creates an extra file. Computer Rep handles it but it's noise to avoid.

A.6 Meet Maestro behavior (what to expect)

Race numbers and meet numbers. Dolphin saves files named like `008-000-00F0004.csv`:

- First three digits (`008`) = Meet #
- Last digits (`0004`) = Race #

- Each Reset increments the Race #

Meet Maestro tracks the current Meet # and Race # in the timing bar. When you advance to a new heat in Meet Maestro, Race # auto-increments. When a matching race file appears in the data directory, **Load Times** activates.

Editing the Race # is sometimes necessary when reality drifts from the auto-counter — typically because of a false start (which still increments the Dolphin race counter) or pre-meet test heats. Click the Race # in the Meet Maestro timing bar to edit, click OK to save, then load times.

Race-per-heat: Normal operation is one Race # per heat. False starts produce extra Race #s that need to be skipped on the Maestro side.

Combined heats: When you've combined two heats by splitting lanes (e.g., heat 1 in lanes 1–3, heat 2 in lanes 4–6), Dolphin sees a single race. Both Meet Maestro heats need to load the same Race # — for the second heat, set the Race # field manually to match. You'll get a "loaded data for empty lanes" message; that's expected and can be ignored.

A.7 Troubleshooting

"Connected" is not green / Meet # box is not green in Meet Maestro. The data directories don't match. Re-check both, ensuring the exact same path is selected in both apps. After fixing, in Dolphin you may need to switch the data directory away and back to force it to re-read the events file. Alternative: in Dolphin, go to **Events → Load** and select the `event_settings_v01.csv` file directly.

Watches don't show up on Dolphin Signals screen. Check:

1. Channel matches base on every watch and the starter.
2. Watches are turned on and within range of the base.
3. Battery levels (Signals screen shows them — replace anything below 50%).
4. Base is firmly connected via USB.

Watches don't start in Mode 2 or 3. Check:

1. Starter channel matches base and watches.
2. **MAN setting** is OFF on the watches (otherwise they wait for individual button presses).
3. Mode 3 only: starter cable is in the **Start Output / Timer Start** jack, not somewhere else.
4. Battery on the starter and the electronic start system.

A watch won't start in Mode 1. Check the **MAN setting** on the watch — it must be ON for manual start/stop.

Result file isn't written after the race.

- Mode 1: at least one Lane Timer didn't press Reset. Use the Reset button (R) in Dolphin to force a reset and write the file.
- Modes 2/3: the Starting Official didn't press Reset. Same fix.

Times load into the wrong race. Edit the Race # in Meet Maestro's Dolphin timing bar to match the Dolphin file you actually want, click OK, then Load Times.

Dolphin software was closed and reopened mid-meet. A new Meet # is now active. To load times saved under the previous Meet #, click the gear icon on the Meet Maestro Dolphin timing bar, change the Meet # selection from the new (current) Meet to the previous one. After that, loading proceeds normally. (This is also why you write down the Meet # at the start.)

Extra result files appear / data does not match Meet Maestro.

- Mode 1: Lane Timers may be pressing Start/Stop/Reset between events when no race is happening. Train them to only operate the watches during events.
- Modes 2/3: a false start created an extra Race # that wasn't accounted for. Skip that Race # in Meet Maestro.

Signal dips on a particular watch. Battery low, or obstruction between the lane and the base. Move the base higher if possible, or relocate it for better line of sight to the lane timers.

Dolphin software won't start, "No base unit detected!" USB cable issue. Try a different cable or USB port. Confirm both ends are firmly connected.

Touchpads: Meet Maestro does not have full touchpad integration with the Dolphin system. NWSC regular-season dual meets use Mode 1, 2, or 3 above without touchpads. (Touchpad-based timing is used at NWSC Invitational meets via a different timing system, which is outside the scope of this guide.)

A.8 References

- CTS Dolphin User Guide F912 — full reference
- CTS Dolphin Setup F911 — hardware setup
- CTS Dolphin Computer Operator Quick Ref F922
- CTS Dolphin Starter Quick Ref F923
- CTS Dolphin Lane Timer Quick Ref F924
- CTS Manuals (full library)
- SwimTopia: CTS Dolphin Integration Overview
- SwimTopia: CTS Dolphin Setup Guide
- SwimTopia: Running Meet Maestro with CTS Dolphin
- CTS Support: support@coloradotime.com / +1 970-667-1000 / 800-287-0653

Appendix B — What's New (Since August 2025)

This appendix summarizes meaningful changes across SwimTopia, Meet Maestro, and the CTS Dolphin software/hardware **since the start of August 2025** (covering Meet Maestro versions 8.35 through 8.38). It's intended for returning Computer Reps who already know the basics and want to know what's different from the prior season.

For the authoritative running list, the Meet Maestro Version History and SwimTopia "What's New" articles are updated continuously. When refreshing this appendix for the next season, **start from Meet Maestro v8.39 / December 2025 onward**.

B.1 Meet Maestro — changes affecting day-of workflow

Stale-meet warning when Dolphin data directory is older than 24 hours (v8.35.0, August 5, 2025). When you point Meet Maestro at a Dolphin data directory whose Meet # was created more than 24 hours ago, Meet Maestro now warns you. This catches the common mistake of opening last weekend's data folder by accident. If you're hosting a meet on the same day you do testing, this won't fire; it only fires across overnight gaps. See Appendix A.6 for related guidance on Meet # tracking.

Locked meets reject division and double-dual changes (v8.35.0). Once a meet is locked (see §5.3), you can no longer change division settings or double-dual configuration. Previously these slipped through and could corrupt scoring on already-published results. If you need to fix one of these post-lock, the meet must be unlocked, the change made, and then re-locked and re-transferred — coordinate with both Meet Directors before doing this.

Alternates handling on Heat Sheets (v8.35.0):

- Once an alternate is assigned a specific heat and lane, they no longer appear in the "alternates" section of the Heat Sheet — only in their assigned lane. Previously they showed in both places, which confused tent parents and ready bench.
- Alternates listed in the alternates section are now ordered fastest-to-slowest by seed time. Easier to scan when you're reseeding around a late scratch.

Heat sheet & session report time zones (v8.36.0, August 22, 2025). Estimated start times on the Heat Sheet and Session Report now display in the meet's local time zone rather than the viewer's. If your team had volunteers across time zones generating reports last season and getting confusing times, that's fixed now.

Athlete Check-in Report — division badges with session/medley filters (v8.36.0). The Athlete Check-in Report now correctly shows division badges when you filter by session or view a medley relay. Previously badges were silently dropped in those views.

Swim-up icons visible on Athlete and Relay Details forms (v8.36.0). When viewing or editing an Athlete or Relay Details form, swim-up indicators now display directly. Helps confirm at a glance that a swimmer is correctly marked for swim-up eligibility (relevant to NWSC §3.2 swim-up rules) without flipping back to a separate report.

B.2 Meet Maestro — reports

Team Scores Report — separate per-page splits (v8.38.0, November 7–10, 2025). The Team Scores report can now render Men's, Women's, and Combined scores on separate pages instead of one

combined page. Useful when distributing to coaches or sponsors where one audience only wants their slice.

Team Scores Report — group by athlete age group (v8.38.0). New option to group team scores by athlete age group. Useful at championship-style meets and for season summaries; not commonly needed for typical NWSC dual scoring.

B.3 Meet Maestro — Dolphin integration changes

Click-on-integration shortcut (v8.37.0, September 8, 2025). Clicking on the Dolphin integration in the timing system bar now jumps directly to the configure screen. Saves a click compared to going through Settings → Timing Setup.

B.4 SwimTopia and mobile app

No major SwimTopia or mobile app changes in the August 2025 – April 2026 window that materially affect the Computer Rep role. Continued maintenance and minor UX improvements on the team management side, but nothing that changes meet-day workflow.

B.5 CTS Dolphin

No new Dolphin software, firmware, or hardware releases in the August 2025 – April 2026 window. The current published Dolphin software is **v5.0.19**. The minimum firmware versions documented in Appendix A.3 (Watches/Base ≥ 1.51, Starter ≥ 1.31 for older hardware; v2.00+ / v3.00+ for the Spring 2023 hardware refresh) remain accurate.

If your team's Dolphin gear hasn't been updated since the prior season, plan a pre-season firmware check — see Appendix A.4 for the verification procedure.

B.6 What this means for the Computer Rep's day-of workflow

The shorter list this season — most changes are quality-of-life fixes rather than new behaviors. The items most likely to affect a returning Rep:

1. **The 24-hour-old-meet warning will catch you if you're testing the day before** and re-open the same data directory the morning of. Acknowledge the warning and proceed if the meet is correct, or create a fresh data directory if not.
2. **You can no longer change division/double-dual settings on a locked meet.** If a coach asks for a division correction post-lock, you'll have to unlock first and coordinate the re-publish.
3. **Heat sheet alternates display changed** — assigned alternates show only in their lane, and the alternates list is sorted fastest-to-slowest. Volunteers used to last season's behavior may briefly notice.
4. **Time zone bug on heat sheets is fixed.** If you saw this last year and worked around it, you can stop working around it.

Appendix C — Tri-meet specifics

Most NWSC dual meets involve two teams. A tri-meet brings three teams to a single facility, and a few things change for the Computer Rep. Most teams will go a season or two without hosting or attending one — when it happens, this appendix collects what's different.

C.1 What changes vs. a dual meet

A tri-meet is procedurally a dual meet with one extra team's worth of entries, but the differences add up:

- **Three databases need to merge instead of two.** Each visiting team delivers their database to the home team by Tuesday midnight per MOM §2.2.1. The home Computer Rep merges all three into one Meet Maestro database and delivers the merged result to all three teams (and all three Meet Directors) by Wednesday midnight. The merge process in SwimTopia/Maestro handles three-team merges natively — the steps are the same, you just confirm Ready for two visiting teams instead of one.
- **All lanes are used from the start.** In a dual meet, even-numbered lanes are home and odd are visiting until the field fills out (per MOM §2.2.1.3.1). In a tri-meet, all lanes are needed from heat one to fit three teams' entries, so the home/visitor lane convention doesn't apply. Meet Maestro handles this automatically when you've set up the meet as a tri-meet, but it's worth confirming during the merge that lanes look right.
- **Scoring rules change.** Per MOM §2.4.6, two-team meets default to Official Meet scoring (4-2-1 individual, 5-3-1 relay) while meets with three or more teams default to Divisional Meet scoring (9-7-6-5-4-3-2-1 individual, with ribbons through 12th). The home and visiting Meet Directors should agree on the scoring system before the meet; the Computer Rep applies whichever they pick. Meet Maestro's scoring rule is set in **Settings → Seeding & Scoring** before any results are entered.
- **Ribbons through 12th place.** Tri-meets award ribbons through 12th instead of 8th. Make sure your label run accounts for the additional places — the Avery 5160 label count per event roughly doubles in a tri-meet. Plan paper accordingly.
- **More relay teams in each event.** Each team can field a relay per age group, so events with relays now have three relay teams instead of two. With more relays comes more incomplete-relay flags, more coordination with three head coaches, and more printing.

C.2 Coordination logistics

Three teams means three computer reps, three meet directors, three head coaches. The key shifts:

- **Combo decisions need three-way agreement.** §1.4's "Who decides what" framework assumes home and visiting Meet Directors. In a tri-meet, all three Meet Directors need to agree — same standard (mutual agreement), but more coordination overhead.
- **Combos are usually unnecessary.** Three teams typically fill heats more completely, so the small-heat combo opportunities that surface in dual meets often don't exist in tri-meets. The Computer Rep can still flag candidates, but expect fewer.
- **Disqualification slip flow involves three head coaches.** §4.3's workflow assumes home and visiting head coaches — adapt to deliver each team's slips to their own head coach.

- **More physical infrastructure at the host pool.** Three pit areas, three tents, three sets of timer assignments. The Computer Rep doesn't typically own this, but it affects how quickly check-in sheets and heat sheets get distributed Saturday morning.

C.3 Meet Maestro setup for tri-meets

When the home Computer Rep creates the meet in SwimTopia/Meet Maestro:

1. Create the meet as a multi-team meet — typically the team that built the SwimTopia Meet Template will have set this up correctly already, but verify under **Settings → Meet Setup** that the meet shows three participating teams.
2. After the merge, all three teams' rosters appear in **Settings → Athletes**. Filter by team to verify entry counts look right for each team.
3. **Settings → Seeding & Scoring** should reflect the agreed scoring system (typically Divisional Meet scoring per MOM §2.4.6 default). Do not change this after results have been entered — Meet Maestro will recalculate, but you may confuse coaches who expected a different points system.
4. Heat sheets render with all three teams' swimmers in each heat. The "all-teams versions" file naming convention (§3.4) still applies — the F in `HSF_*` covers however many teams are participating.

C.4 What stays the same

To keep the change list bounded, here's what works exactly like a dual meet:

- The pre-meet weekly workflow (§1.1 through §1.7) — same steps, three teams instead of two
- Phase 3 morning sequence (Dolphin first, timer sheets, relay-then-individual heat sheet printing) — identical
- Phase 4 data entry and DQ slip processing — same Meet Maestro workflow
- Phase 5 post-meet results publication and record book updates — same
- The MOM deadlines (§2.2.1) — same: Tuesday midnight visiting databases, Wednesday midnight merged database, Thursday 8 PM heat sheets, Friday 8 PM final deviations

C.5 Practical advice

- **Build extra time into the morning.** Three teams' worth of last-minute scratches and reseeds in the same 30-minute pre-meet window is tighter than a dual. If you have a parallel-printing arrangement with the visiting teams (§3.4), it's especially valuable here.
- **Confirm the scoring system in writing.** Don't rely on a verbal "we'll do dual scoring" between Meet Directors — get it in the Meet Notes or an email so all three Computer Reps are working from the same plan.
- **Clarify ribbon ownership early.** With ribbons through 12th, label production roughly doubles. Confirm with the Team Coordinator that the label volunteers are prepared for the larger run.

Pre-Meet Checklist (Print and Pack)

💡 **RECOMMENDED** — Each item is tagged with its tier so the list is readable in color or black-and-white: **[REQ]** = 📋 Required (MOM/NWSC mandate), **[REC]** = 💡 Recommended (circuit best practice), **[STN]** = ⭐ Steiner Practice (one team's habit; adapt to your team).

The checklist is grouped by when each task happens. Items within a group are listed in the order they're typically performed.

Sunday → Tuesday (early-week)

- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 Parent/swimmer registration in SwimTopia closes per team-defined deadline (typically Sunday/Monday of meet week)
- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 Head Coach reviews entries: confirms events, sets relay seed assignments, flags any swim-up requests (§1.1)
- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 All known absences entered/reflected in SwimTopia (§1.1)
- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 Relay Report reviewed with Head Coach (or per standing methodology); exhibition relays noted (§1.1)
- ☐ **[REQ]** 📋 (🛫 only) Meet locked in SwimTopia and marked Ready · sends visiting team's database to Home Computer Rep · **Tuesday midnight deadline (MOM §2.2.1)** (§1.2)
- ☐ **[REQ]** 📋 (🏠 only) Meet locked in SwimTopia and marked Ready · receive visiting team's database by Tuesday midnight per MOM §2.2.1 (§1.2)

Wednesday (merge day)

- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 (🏠 only) Record books attached in SwimTopia (after both teams have marked Ready and entries are locked, but before the merge — §1.2)
- ☐ **[REQ]** 📋 (🏠 only) Visiting and home databases merged in SwimTopia → produces the merged Meet Maestro database (§1.2)
- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 (🏠 only) Meet Maestro start time, padding, and breaks configured *after* the merge but *before* combo decisions (§1.3)
- ☐ **[REQ]** 📋 (🏠 only) Combo plan finalized with both Meet Directors and lane assignments implemented in Meet Maestro (Wednesday afternoon — §1.4)
- ☐ **[REQ]** 📋 (🏠 only) Merged meet database delivered to all directors and Visiting Computer Rep · **Wednesday midnight deadline (MOM §2.2.1)** (§1.2)
- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 (🛫 only) Wednesday-night merged database received from Home Computer Rep (§1.4)

Thursday (heat sheet day)

- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 Check-in sheets printed and PDF saved (§1.5)
- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 Session Report saved and emailed to coaches/coordinators — note the combo-blindness caveat in §1.6 when distributing
- ☐ **[REQ]** 📋 (🏠 only) Heat sheets delivered to both Meet Directors and Visiting Computer Rep by Thursday 8 PM per MOM §2.2.1 (§1.7)
- ☐ **[REC]** 💡 Heat sheets archived and shared with Team Coordinator for website (§1.7)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Heat sheets *published* in Meet Maestro mobile app (publication is opt-in — don't forget to flip the switch) (§1.7)

☐ **[STN]** ⭐ Backup reports (Athlete Report Card, Best Times) saved (Steiner habit — §1.8)

Friday (final prep)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Late absences from Wednesday merge through Friday confirmed in Meet Maestro (§2.1)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Relay Report rerun; broken-relay decisions noted with Head Coach (§2.1; team practice varies — see §2.1 callout)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Combo plan reviewed against current entries (default: leave it alone unless entries have shifted significantly — §2.1)

☐ **[STN]** ⭐ Meet Notes updated with relay restrictions (Steiner workflow — §2.2)

☐ **[STN]** ⭐ Saturday-morning swimmer attendance form pre-seeded with everything known (Steiner habit — §2.1)

☐ **[REQ]** 📋 Final preparatory deviations confirmed between both Meet Directors by Friday 8 PM per MOM §2.2.1

Saturday morning, before meet start (🏠 hosts only — runs in parallel)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Dolphin timing system tested end-to-end first thing — Dolphin must be talking to Meet Maestro before anything else proceeds (§3.5; see Appendix A)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Combined heats sheet printed if applicable (before timer and stroke/exchange judges meetings — §3.5)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Timer sheets printed and handed off to Head Timer for the timer meeting (§3.4)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 First-half **relay** heat sheets printed first (events 1–11) — guarantees meet starts on time; **Stroke Judges, Exchange Judges, and Ready Bench get copies first** (all-teams versions), then coaches, coordinators, scorers, tent parents (§3.4)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Remaining first-half heat sheets printed (events 12–47) once relay sheets are distributed; same priority order (§3.4)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 DQ codes sheet printed — least time-sensitive; can be printed any time before scoring starts (§3.5)

Pack and bring (any time before leaving)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Avery 5160 labels (for award and time-improvement labels)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Backup paper and toner/ink confirmed

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Laptop, charger (database transfers happen through SwimTopia/Meet Maestro — no USB needed)

☐ **[REC]** 💡 Printed copy of this guide

Further Reading

NWSC league site (nwsc.swimtopia.com):

- NWSC Documents — current Meet Operations Manual, Code of Conduct, USA Swimming Rulebook, official DQ slip, and Timer Lane Assignment Sheet
- NWSC Meet Software — official download links for Meet Maestro Desktop and Dolphin software (the only timing system supported in NWSC duals)
- NWSC Record Book — circuit-wide records, separate from team-level record books on each team's SwimTopia site
- NWSC Invitational Cuts — qualifying time standards used for end-of-season Invitational seeding
- NWSC Training Materials — Stroke/Turn/Exchange/Head Timer training and Starter training (Computer Rep training is not on the league site; this guide fills that gap)
- 2026 NWSC Divisions — current divisional alignment

SwimTopia / Meet Maestro:

- Meet Maestro – Best Practices for Running a Successful Meet
- Meet Maestro Quick Start Guide
- Meet Maestro – Accessing Your Meets
- Meet Maestro – Results Entry and Actions
- Meet Maestro Settings – Finish & Export
- Meet Maestro Version History
- SwimTopia Help Center (full)

Colorado Time Systems / Dolphin:

- CTS Dolphin Software Download
- CTS Support Manuals — F912 Dolphin Extended Instructions and related references

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This training guide is maintained by the NWSC circuit Computer Rep team. Suggestions and corrections welcome.